

TrustLock Admin Training Manual

Internal Operations & Procedures Guide

Version 2.0 — Confidential

For authorized admin staff only. Do not distribute.

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1. Welcome & Role Overview

Welcome to TrustLock. You are part of a platform that provides escrow-based payment protection for cross-border B2B transactions. Your role as Admin Staff is critical to maintaining trust between buyers and vendors.

As Admin Staff, your primary function is to serve as the communication bridge between platform users (buyers and vendors) and the chain of command (Chief Admins). You are the first point of contact for all user inquiries.

IMPORTANT: Admin Staff do NOT have authority to settle disputes, approve payouts, manage compliance flags, or make financial decisions. These actions are reserved for Chief Admins only.

Your core responsibilities:

1. Respond to user messages promptly and professionally
2. Escalate issues to the chain of command with clear context
3. Maintain awareness of ongoing transactions and their status
4. Follow the anonymity protocol — users only see your agent alias (e.g., TL-Agent-XXXX)
5. Log all actions with justifications when required

2. Chain of Command & Hierarchy

TrustLock operates with a strict hierarchical command structure:

Rank 1 — Original Chief Admin (Michael)

Has absolute authority over all platform operations. Only the Original Chief can: add/delete/reinstate admin staff, promote other admins to Chief, demote Chiefs, and make final override decisions on disputes. If the Original Chief is removed from the system, succession automatically passes to the next Chief by chronological order.

Rank 2+ — Promoted Chief Admins

Have full operational authority: settle disputes, execute payouts via Admin OS Pay, approve/reject KYC, and manage compliance flags. Cannot manage staff or access Accountability/Staff Management portals.

Regular Admin Staff

Restricted to non-sensitive modules: Overview, Emmanuel AI, Messages, Industry Playbook, TL-ID Diagnostics, and Training Manual. Cannot access Finance, Analytics, Reports, Documents, Compliance, or Dispute resolution.

3. Getting Started — First Login & Setup

When your account is created, you will receive:

1. A username (e.g., sarah.tl)
2. A one-time temporary password (8 characters)

Steps to activate your account:

1. Navigate to the admin login page
2. Enter your username and temporary password
3. You will be redirected to the Setup page
4. Set your permanent password (must be strong)
5. Add your email address for password recovery
6. Complete your initial setup

NOTE: The temporary password expires after first use. If you lose it before logging in, contact the Chief Admin for a reinstatement (which generates a new temporary password).

4. Admin Dashboard Navigation

Section	Purpose	Staff Access	Chief Access
Overview	Dashboard summary	View only	View only
Transactions	All escrow transactions	View only	Full
Disputes	Open disputes & AI recs	View only	Settle & Override
Workflow Tracker	Milestone progress	View only	View only
Emmanuel AI	AI assistant	Full	Full
Vendors	Vendor accounts, KYC	View only	Full
Buyers	Buyer accounts	View only	Full
Compliance	AML/KYC flags	View only	Full
Analytics	Revenue & charts	No access	Full
Reports	Summary reports	No access	Full
Documents	Archived files	No access	Full
Messages	User support inbox	Full	Full
OS Pay	Fund movements	No access	Full
Accountability	Action log	No access	Rank 1 only
Staff Manager	Staff lifecycle	No access	Rank 1 only
Training Manual	This document	View & download	View & download

5. Your Primary Responsibility: Messaging

The Messages section is your main workspace.

How Messages Are Routed

All user messages (from buyers and vendors) are routed to a shared inbox. Every admin can see every message. When you open a message thread and respond, you 'claim' that thread. Other admins will see that you are handling it.

Anonymity Protocol

Users NEVER see your real name. They only see 'TrustLock Support'. Your agent alias (TL-Agent-XXXX) is only visible to other admins. The Chief Admin (Rank 1) can resolve aliases to real names for accountability.

Response Guidelines:

- Always be professional and concise
- Never promise outcomes you cannot deliver
- Never disclose internal procedures, AI recommendations, or staff names
- Never reveal blockchain details, fee structures, or platform revenue
- Acknowledge receipt within 2 hours during business hours

6. Message Handling Scripts & Templates

Use these pre-approved response templates for common situations. Customize as needed but maintain the tone and boundaries.

Script A — Greeting & Acknowledgement

"Thank you for reaching out to TrustLock Support. I've reviewed your inquiry and I'm here to help. Let me look into this for you right away."

Script B — Status Update Request

"I can see your transaction [TX-ID] is currently in [STATUS] status. [If locked]: Your funds are securely held in escrow. [If shipped]: The vendor has confirmed shipment. [If delivered]: Awaiting your confirmation of receipt. Is there anything specific about this transaction I can clarify?"

Script C — Escalation Notification

"I understand the urgency of your concern. This matter requires attention from our senior resolution team. I've escalated your case with full context and you will be updated as soon as a decision is made. Your reference number is [TX-ID]."

Script D — Dispute Filed by User

"I've documented your dispute regarding transaction [TX-ID]. Our resolution team will review all evidence from both parties before making a determination. Please upload any supporting documents through your dashboard. You will receive updates as the review progresses."

Script E — Angry/Threatening User

"I understand your frustration and I take your concerns seriously. Let me escalate this to our senior team immediately so we can work toward a resolution. All communications and transaction records are preserved for your protection. Your reference: [TX-ID]."

NEVER argue, blame, or be defensive. NEVER say 'calm down'. Acknowledge their emotion and escalate.

Script F — User Asking Who They're Speaking To

"You are speaking with TrustLock Support. How can I assist you today?"

Never reveal your agent alias, real name, or any staff information.

Script G — User Asking for Refund

"I understand you'd like a refund on transaction [TX-ID]. Refund decisions are made by our senior resolution team based on the transaction terms and evidence. I'm escalating this now. You'll receive an update once a determination is made."

Script H — KYC Hold Inquiry

"For transactions above our compliance threshold, identity verification is required by regulatory policy. Please complete the verification steps in your dashboard under the KYC section. Once approved, your transaction will automatically proceed. If you need assistance with the verification process, I'm here to help."

7. Escalation Protocol

When an issue exceeds your authority, follow these steps:

1. Document the user's issue clearly in the thread
2. Add an internal note summarizing the situation for the Chief Admin
3. Use the case status dropdown to mark the thread as 'escalated'
4. Inform the user that their case has been escalated
5. Monitor the thread for Chief Admin response

Issues That **ALWAYS** Require Escalation:

- Any dispute or disagreement between buyer and vendor
- Requests for refunds or fund releases
- Compliance flags or suspicious activity
- KYC verification issues
- Payment processing errors
- User threats (legal or otherwise)
- Any action that would modify transaction status

8. What Admin Staff **CANNOT** Do

This list is exhaustive. Attempting these actions will be blocked by the system and logged:

- Settle or resolve disputes
- Release escrowed funds
- Approve or reject payouts
- Modify transaction status
- Approve or reject KYC documents
- Override AI recommendations
- Modify compliance flags
- Change vendor tiers or billing plans
- Create or modify work orders
- Access Gas Treasury or blockchain anchoring controls
- Add, delete, reinstate, or manage other admin accounts
- Modify platform settings
- Generate or sign legal documents
- Access Admin OS Pay or execute fund movements

9. What Chief Admins **CAN** Do

Chief Admins (Rank 1 and Rank 2+) have full operational authority:

- All messaging functions (same as staff)
- Settle disputes with documented reasoning
- Execute fund movements via Admin OS Pay (Release, Refund, Split)

- Approve/reject KYC documents and manage verification holds
- Override AI dispute recommendations (with 48-hour window)
- Review and act on compliance flags
- Access Analytics, Reports, Documents, and Finance sections
- Manage blockchain anchoring and gas treasury

Rank 1 (Original Chief) additionally can:

- Add/delete/reinstate admin staff
- Promote admins to Chief or demote Chiefs back to staff
- Final override on any system decision
- Access Accountability portal and Staff Management

10. Work Order Panel — Admin Role Clarity

The MilestoneWorkOrderPanel in the Admin Transactions view is READ-ONLY OVERSIGHT. Admins see:

- Dual-status badges (fulfillment status + payment status)
- Industry blueprint and compliance requirements
- Milestone progress and document checklists
- Step-by-step guides showing what buyers and vendors need to do

However, admins do NOT drive any actions from the work order panel itself. Their actionable tasks happen in dedicated panels:

Panel	Admin Action	When to Use
Disputes Panel	Decide outcome: Buyer Wins (100% refund), Vendor Wins (100% release), or Split (percentage compromise)	When a dispute has been filed and evidence reviewed
Admin OS Pay	Execute the fund movement based on the dispute decision or normal release approval	After dispute decision is final, or when milestone release is approved
KYC Queue	Approve or reject identity verification holds	When a transaction is in kyc_hold status (>\$5,000)
Compliance Flags	Review auto-frozen transactions and clear or escalate flags	When compliance_hold is triggered by AML screening

KEY PRINCIPLE: The work order panel provides visibility. The action panels provide authority. Never confuse oversight with control.

11. Chief Admin: Dispute Resolution Procedures

This section details the exact step-by-step procedure a Chief Admin must follow when resolving disputes. These procedures are mandatory and auditable.

Phase 1 — Evidence Review (Mandatory Before Any Decision)

1. Open the dispute from the Disputes panel
2. Review the AI recommendation and confidence score from Emmanuel
3. Read ALL evidence uploaded by both parties (buyer and vendor)
4. Review the transaction timeline: when was it locked, shipped, delivered?
5. Check milestone document gates — were required documents submitted?
6. Review any message threads between the parties for context
7. Check compliance flags — are there any AML/sanctions concerns?

NEVER skip evidence review. Every dispute decision must be based on documented evidence, not assumptions.

Phase 2 — Decision Framework

Scenario A: Clear Vendor Fault (non-delivery, wrong item, fraud)

1. Verify buyer's claim against shipping/tracking records
2. Check if vendor responded to the dispute within the platform
3. If vendor is non-responsive after 48 hours → Buyer Wins (100% refund)
4. Document your reasoning in the justification field
5. Proceed to Admin OS Pay → Execute 100% Refund to Buyer

Scenario B: Clear Buyer Fault (confirmed delivery, buyer's remorse)

1. Verify delivery confirmation (tracking, signed documents, photos)
2. Check if the buyer acknowledged receipt in the platform
3. If delivery is confirmed and product matches description → Vendor Wins (100% release)
4. Document evidence and reasoning
5. Proceed to Admin OS Pay → Execute 100% Release to Vendor

Scenario C: Partial Fault / Compromise Needed

1. Both parties have valid claims (e.g., partial delivery, quality issues)
2. Review industry-specific standards (e.g., AQL for textiles, SGS for commodities)
3. Determine fair split percentage based on evidence
4. Common splits: 70/30, 60/40, 50/50 — based on severity
5. Document the specific reasoning for the chosen percentage
6. Proceed to Admin OS Pay → Execute Split Pay with the determined percentage

Scenario D: High-Value Dispute ($\geq$ \$10,000)

1. Apply the standard arbitration fee (2% of disputed amount)
2. Follow ICC-binding arbitration rules
3. Both parties must accept the ruling via the platform
4. If either party rejects → escalate to Rank 1 Chief for final override
5. Document everything — 7-year retention applies

Scenario E: Stale Order (Vendor Non-Responsive)

1. Check if vendor has been unresponsive for >14 days after escrow lock
2. Verify no shipment confirmation or milestone updates exist
3. Apply Stale Order Protection → 100% Refund to Buyer
4. Flag vendor account for review

Phase 3 — Override Protocol (Rank 1 Only)

If the Original Chief (Rank 1) disagrees with a dispute resolution made by a Rank 2+ Chief:

1. Navigate to the Accountability panel → Chief Override section
2. Select the dispute to override
3. Provide a detailed override reason (mandatory)
4. Set the override window (default: 48 hours)
5. The original resolution is preserved as 'original_resolution'
6. The countdown timer begins — the override must be finalized within the window
7. Execute the corrected decision via Admin OS Pay
8. Both the original and override decisions are permanently logged

Override authority exists to ensure justice, not to micromanage. Use it sparingly and only when evidence clearly contradicts the original decision.

12. Chief Admin: Admin OS Pay Execution Procedures

Admin OS Pay is the financial execution tool. It turns dispute decisions into actual fund movements. This section details exact procedures.

Pre-Execution Checklist (Before Every OS Pay Action)

1. Confirm the dispute decision has been documented and logged
2. Verify the transaction ID matches the dispute
3. Confirm the correct amounts (principal, fees, splits)
4. Verify recipient wallet/account information is correct
5. Check that no compliance holds are active on the transaction
6. Confirm you have Chief Admin authority for this action

Procedure A — 100% Release to Vendor

1. Open Admin OS Pay from the sidebar
2. Select 'Release' action
3. Enter the transaction ID
4. System calculates: Vendor receives (Amount - 1.0% TrustLock fee)
5. Review the breakdown: gross amount, fee, net to vendor
6. Confirm and sign the release
7. System anchors the release to Polygon blockchain
8. Vendor receives funds in their internal balance
9. Vendor can then withdraw via their preferred method (crypto, bank, mobile money)

Procedure B — 100% Refund to Buyer

1. Open Admin OS Pay from the sidebar
2. Select 'Refund' action
3. Enter the transaction ID
4. System returns 100% of locked funds to buyer
5. No TrustLock fee is charged on refunds
6. Confirm and sign the refund
7. Blockchain proof is generated
8. Buyer receives funds in their internal balance for withdrawal

Procedure C — Split Pay (Compromise)

1. Open Admin OS Pay from the sidebar
2. Select 'Split' action
3. Enter the transaction ID
4. Set the split percentage (e.g., 70% vendor / 30% buyer)
5. System calculates: Vendor share = (Amount × vendor%) - 1.0% fee on vendor's share

6. Buyer share = Amount × buyer% (no fee on refund portion)
7. Review the full breakdown before confirming
8. Confirm and sign the split
9. Both parties receive their respective amounts in internal balances
10. Blockchain proof records the exact split ratios

Post-Execution Steps (After Every OS Pay Action)

1. Verify the blockchain proof was generated (check Blockchain Proofs panel)
2. Confirm the transaction status updated correctly
3. Send a message to both parties confirming the outcome
4. Archive all related documents (auto-generated, but verify)
5. Log the action in the Action Log with justification

13. Chief Admin: Step-by-Step Decision Framework

Use this framework as a mental checklist before making any financial decision.

The 5-Question Test

Before executing any dispute resolution or fund movement, answer these five questions:

- 1. EVIDENCE: Have I reviewed ALL evidence from BOTH parties?
- 2. TIMELINE: Does the transaction timeline support this decision?
- 3. POLICY: Does this decision align with TrustLock dispute policy?
- 4. PROPORTIONALITY: Is the remedy proportional to the harm?
- 5. DOCUMENTATION: Have I documented my reasoning clearly enough that another Chief could understand my decision months later?

If the answer to ANY of these is 'No', do NOT proceed. Gather more information first.

Industry-Specific Considerations

Industry	Key Consideration	Common Dispute Trigger
Manufacturing	Check SGS/inspection reports	Quality below spec
Agriculture	Verify phytosanitary certs	Spoilage, grade disputes
Textiles	Apply AQL sampling standards	Defect rate exceeds tolerance
Pharmaceuticals	Check cold chain/temp logs	Temperature excursion
Freelancing	Review milestone deliverables	Scope creep, incomplete work
E-commerce	Check tracking + delivery proof	Item not as described
Real Estate	Verify title + inspection reports	Undisclosed defects
Construction	Review progress photos + permits	Delays, scope changes
Automotive	Check VIN verification + mileage	Mechanical issues
Logistics	Review BOL + insurance claims	Damage in transit

14. AI Tools Available to You

Emmanuel AI (Admin AI Assistant)

Emmanuel is your on-demand AI advisor with 8 analytical tools: risk_score, vendor_health, fraud_patterns, transaction_timeline, compliance_check, industry_playbook, dispute_history, and payout_analysis.

How to Use Emmanuel Effectively:

Be specific. Instead of 'What is happening with the order?', ask 'What is the current status of transaction TL-2025-0042 and are there any compliance flags?'

Command Palette (Cmd+K / Ctrl+K)

Press Cmd+K (Mac) or Ctrl+K (Windows) from anywhere to search transactions, documents, users, or navigate quickly.

15. Shared Inbox Protocol

The Shared Inbox (under Accountability) is for internal admin coordination, separate from user Messages. Use it to:

- Coordinate case handoffs between staff
- Discuss complex cases before escalating
- Track which cases are open/closed
- Leave internal notes on threads for Chief Admin review

16. Action Logging & Accountability

Every action is logged: messages sent, threads claimed, escalations, pages accessed. Actions that deviate from standard protocol are flagged and automatically escalated for Chief Admin review.

NEVER attempt to circumvent the logging system. All attempts are tracked and reported.

17. Understanding Transactions & Escrow

Transaction Lifecycle:

- **PENDING** — Order created, awaiting payment
- **LOCKED** — Funds received and held in escrow (USDC or USDT on Polygon)
- **SHIPPED** — Vendor has shipped goods/delivered service
- **DELIVERED** — Buyer confirms receipt
- **RELEASED** — Funds released to vendor via Admin OS Pay
- **DISPUTED** — Either party has raised a dispute
- **KYC_HOLD** — Paused pending identity verification (>\$5,000)
- **COMPLIANCE_HOLD** — Frozen due to AML/compliance flag

Transaction Types: Simple (one-time), Milestone (multi-phase with document gates), Hybrid (upfront + milestones).

18. Understanding Disputes

Disputes are handled EXCLUSIVELY by Chief Admins. Staff role:

1. Listen to the user's complaint and document details
2. Escalate to Chief Admin with full context
3. Inform the user: "Your dispute has been escalated to our senior resolution team."

NEVER promise a specific outcome. NEVER suggest who is at fault. NEVER share AI recommendations with users.

19. Compliance & KYC Basics

TrustLock enforces AML and KYC requirements:

- All vendors undergo KYC verification
- Transactions over \$5,000 trigger automatic KYC holds
- Sanctions screening runs on all parties
- Document scanning AI checks for forgery indicators

If a user asks about KYC, direct them to their dashboard's verification section. Escalate issues to Chief Admin.

20. Blockchain Proof Awareness

Every transaction generates blockchain proofs anchored to the Polygon network: escrow locks, fund releases, dispute filings/resolutions, document attestations, milestone completions, KYC verifications, payout confirmations.

Both USDC and USDT (Polygon) are supported as escrow stablecoins.

21. Document Management

Auto-generated documents during transaction lifecycles:

- Escrow Acknowledgement Forms
- Pre-Order Signatory Contracts
- AML Screening Certificates
- Payout Reconciliation Receipts
- Dispute Evidence Packages

All documents stored for 7 years minimum for regulatory compliance.

22. Security & Session Management

- Never share login credentials
- Never access admin panel from public computers
- Never screenshot or record the admin panel
- Log out when stepping away
- Report suspicious activity to Chief Admin immediately
- If compromised: Chief deletes account → investigation → reinstatement with new credentials

23. Common Scenarios & Responses

Scenario	Response Template
'Where is my money?'	'Your funds are securely held in escrow. Let me check the status of your transaction.'
'I want a refund'	'Refund requests are handled by our senior resolution team. I am escalating this now.'
Vendor not shipping	'I can see your order was locked on [date]. Let me escalate this to our resolution team.'
KYC hold inquiry	'Identity verification is required by compliance policy. Please complete the steps in your dashboard.'
Legal threat	'We take all concerns seriously. Let me escalate immediately. All records are preserved.'
'Who am I speaking to?'	'You are speaking with TrustLock Support. How can I assist you today?'

24. Difficult Situation Scripts

These scripts are for Chief Admins handling complex or emotionally charged situations.

Script: Informing Buyer of Vendor Win

"After a thorough review of all evidence submitted by both parties, including [specific evidence], our resolution team has determined that the vendor fulfilled their obligations as agreed. The escrowed funds will be released to the vendor. If you believe there is additional evidence that was not considered, you may submit it within 48 hours for a secondary review. Transaction reference: [TX-ID]."

Script: Informing Vendor of Buyer Win

"After reviewing all evidence, including [specific evidence], our resolution team has determined that the buyer's claim is substantiated. A full refund will be issued. If you have additional evidence that was not previously submitted, you may submit it within 48 hours. Transaction reference: [TX-ID]."

Script: Informing Both Parties of Split Decision

"After careful review, our resolution team has determined a compromise is appropriate. Based on [specific reasoning], the funds will be split: [X]% to the vendor and [Y]% to the buyer. This decision considers [brief evidence summary]. Both parties will receive their respective amounts in their platform balance. Transaction reference: [TX-ID]."

Script: Compliance Freeze Notification to User

"Your transaction [TX-ID] has been temporarily held for a routine compliance review. This is a standard security measure to protect all parties. Our compliance team is reviewing the matter and you will be notified once the review is complete. No action is required from you at this time unless our team requests additional information."

Script: Override Decision Communication (Rank 1 Only)

"Upon executive review, the previous resolution for transaction [TX-ID] has been revised. After examining additional evidence and circumstances, the updated determination is [new decision]. This is the final resolution."

Both parties have been notified. All records of both the original and revised decisions are permanently archived."

25. Glossary

Term	Definition
Escrow	Funds held by TrustLock between buyer payment and vendor fulfillment
KYC	Know Your Customer — identity verification requirement
AML	Anti-Money Laundering — regulatory compliance framework
Milestone	A stage in a multi-phase transaction with document gates
TL-ID	TrustLock unique identifier for components and diagnostics
Blockchain Proof	Immutable on-chain record anchored to Polygon network
Gas Fee	Blockchain transaction cost for anchoring proofs
Agent Alias	Your anonymous identifier visible only to other admins
Deviation	Action that goes against standard protocol
Override Window	48-hour period for Chief Admin to reverse a dispute decision
Admin OS Pay	Financial execution tool for releases, refunds, and splits
Work Order	Milestone-based task tracker for transaction fulfillment
Shared Inbox	Internal admin communication for case coordination
USDC/USDT	Stablecoins used for escrow on Polygon network
Split Pay	Compromise resolution where funds are divided between parties

26. Emergency Procedures

Critical Incident Protocol — Escalate IMMEDIATELY to Chief Admin:

- Suspected fraud or money laundering
- System security breach or unauthorized access
- User reporting criminal activity
- Platform downtime or data loss
- Regulatory inquiry or law enforcement contact

Do NOT respond to the user in emergency situations. Acknowledge receipt and escalate.

Account Compromise Protocol:

1. Contact Chief Admin immediately
2. Chief deletes your account (voiding all credentials)
3. After investigation, reinstatement with fresh credentials
4. All actions during compromised period will be audited

— End of Training Manual v2.0 —

For questions about this manual, contact the Chief Admin.

Addendum A — Departmental Structure (v2.1)

Effective June 8, 2026 — Supersedes any prior departmental references in this manual.

Consolidated 6-Department Model

TrustLock now operates with six (6) admin departments. The former separate **Technical & Engineering** and **Operations** departments have been fully consolidated into a single **IT Department**, which now owns every computer- and technical-related responsibility on the platform. There is no remaining standalone Technical/Engineering or Operations department.

Slug	Department	Client Messaging
executive	Executive Office	Yes
correspondence	Correspondence & Client Relations	Yes
disputes	Disputes & Arbitration	No
finance	Finance & Payouts	No
compliance	Compliance & Risk	No
operations	IT Department	No

IT Department — Scope of Responsibility

The IT Department is the single consolidated home for all technology, engineering, and platform-operations work. Its scope includes:

- Transactions oversight and operational support
- Workflow & milestone monitoring
- Vendor and buyer account administration
- Platform configuration and feature toggles
- Blockchain proofs and anchoring oversight
- Gas treasury monitoring and top-ups
- System health monitoring and incident response
- Autonomous Fixer triage and code-defect relay
- Edge function diagnostics and deployment coordination
- Any future computer-, network-, or system-related issues that may arise

Internal Note on the Slug

For database backward-compatibility, the IT Department retains the internal slug operations. This is an implementation detail only — the user-facing name is **IT Department** across the sidebar, departmental assignment screens, and all admin tooling.

Impact on Existing Procedures

Any procedure in earlier sections of this manual that references a separate **Technical & Engineering** team, **Engineering escalation**, or **Operations team** should be read as referring to the consolidated **IT Department**. Escalation paths, on-call rotations, and ownership of System Health, Autonomous Fixer, Blockchain Proofs, and Gas Treasury modules now all route to IT Department staff.